

Acer Iconia Tab iM10-22

Budget tablet that gets the basics right

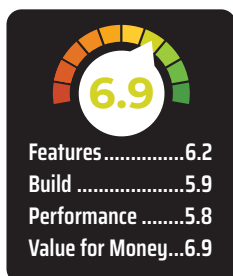


When you think of Acer, tablets might not be the first thing that comes to mind. But with the Acer Iconia Tab iM10-22, it makes a run at the highly competitive and price-sensitive sub-₹20,000 Android tablet market.

The Iconia Tab iM10-22 starts at ₹17,990 and promises a big screen, long battery life, 4G LTE connectivity, along with a surprisingly solid multimedia experience. But does it live up to its spec sheet, or is it another case of over-promising and underdelivering? I spent a couple of weeks with it as my go-to e-book reader and for leisure viewing to find out.

SLEEK & PREMIUM

The Iconia Tab iM10-22 makes a good first impression right out of the box. It's not often that budget Android tablets include extras in the box, but Acer bundles a decent-quality TPU back cover, a pre-applied matte screen protector and a pair of wired earphones, all of which is a rare and welcome move.



Interestingly, there's a pogo pin connector at the bottom for accessories, which might make this a useful productivity tool with the right add-ons. But what those accessories are, is something that the brand has been notably quiet about. It's been months

since this tablet was released, and Acer should have made stylus or keyboard docks available by now. If you visit the Acer website, you'll find just one available accessory, the smart flip cover.

Nonetheless, the Iconia Tab iM10-22 has a metal design with a matte texture in rose gold colour and it feels more premium than its price suggests. There is a subtle Acer logo at the back, a slight camera bump on the corner, and clean edges with a functional port layout.

Overall, it has a solid build, the 475g weight feels balanced in hand, and it fits snugly into most sling bags or pouches.

DISPLAY

The Iconia Tab iM10-22 features a nice 10.36-inch IPS display that offers a 2K

resolution (2000 × 1200 pixels) and is sharp enough for this price range. Text and images look crisp, and videos play smoothly up to 1440p, which makes it a solid choice for reading, browsing the web, or enjoying YouTube videos.

The brightness tops out at about 450 nits, which is adequate for indoors, though you might struggle in bright sunlight. I noticed the pre-applied matte screen protector does a good job cutting down glare, but it somewhat mutes the colours and vibrancy of what you're watching.

Overall, I found the colour reproduction a bit lacking. The tones look somewhat washed out unless you dig into the settings menu for adjustments, and while that's something I can overlook at this price point, it definitely takes away some of the visual impact when watching movies or playing games.

Another small nitpick is the chunky bezels and a white Acer logo planted right at the bottom centre of the front face. It's not enough to make me avoid recommending the tablet, but it does pull your attention away when you're trying to get lost in the screen.

While the display does a good enough job for everyday tasks like reading and viewing, don't expect it to blow you away.

AUDIO & MULTIMEDIA

The Iconia Tab iM10-22 has a quad-speaker setup with Acer's PureVoice tuning, which I was genuinely surprised to see as it delivers sound that's punching well above its price class. The speakers get plenty loud and keep things mostly clear when watching shows or just playing my playlists in the background. The speaker is tuned for a bass-heavy signature which works for most users though it might not please audio purists but considering its price, I am not complaining.

What purists will like, though, is that Acer didn't ditch the headphone jack. Having that 3.5mm port alongside OTG support through the Type-C connection gives you plenty of options for your entertainment needs. It's these